

SYROS INTERNATIONAL MUSIC FESTIVAL 2025

DEMONSTRATING THE HARMONY OF MUSIC AND CULTURE

21-25 OCT 2025

SYROS ISLAND

CYCLADES · GREECE

Artistic Directors



ASI MATATHIAS



TOSCA OPDAM

Executive Director



ALEXANDRE PIKIAKOS

alex@syrosfestival.org

+30 698 1800 593

Production

MEET THE VIOLINS

Cultural non-for-profit association registered in Greece with Tax number 997194151

OVERVIEW OF THE FESTIVAL

The third edition of the festival will take place on Syros 21-25 Oct 2025

Syros, a unique setting for a worldclass festival

- ✓ A rich musical program directed by Tosca Opdam and Asi Matathias
- ✓ The Apollon Theatre a jewel of neoclassical architecture
- ✓ Syros, the island of culture : A prime destination for musicians
- ✓ A Perfect cultural and touristic setting to attract qualified audience

Our vision for the next years

- ✓ Develop chamber music in Greece
- ✓ Become one of the leading classical music festivals in the Mediterranean region
- ✓ Establish Syros Festival as an international Brand

Program of the Festival

- ✓ Five concerts at Apollon Theater
- ✓ An extended Masterclasses program
- ✓ An outreach program for children of the Cyclades Islands
- ✓ Cultural activities

Corporate / Organisation

- ✓ A nonprofit Association founded to produce the Festival
- ✓ A local multidisciplinary Executive team
- ✓ A board of advisors to provide Strategic Guidance



Funding, partners and patrons

- ✓ Funding from public Institutions
- ✓ Sponsorship from corporate businesses
- ✓ Support of local partners
- ✓ A loyalty program for individuals

Travel to Syros

- ✓ Access to Syros Island by Ferry and airplane all year long
- ✓ A packaged offer for travel agents
- ✓ Partnerships with local Hotels, restaurants, travel agents to help provide the best service to our international audience

A UNIQUE SETTING FOR A WORLDCLASS FESTIVAL

In the heart of the Cyclades islands in Greece, the festival features a rich musical program



Conceived and is directed by local artist and entrepreneur **Alex Pikiakos** and violinists **Asi Matathias** and **Tosca Opdam**, the festival consists of a week of captivating music making and chamber concerts that features some of the most sought after international musicians.

The festival features :

- **FIVE CONCERTS** at the The Historic **Apollon Theater**, a mini la Scala
- **AN EXTENDED MASTERCLASS PROGRAM** dedicated to nurturing young, promising musicians from all over the world.
- **AN OUTREACH PROGRAM** with concerts for children from the age of 5-18.
- **A PROGRAM OF ACTIVITIES** for our international audience to immerse themselves in the life and culture of Syros Island

Built in 1864, the Apollon Theatre was designed by the Italian architect Pietro Sampo, who drew inspiration from four iconic Italian theaters, including the renowned La Scala in Milan.

160 **YEARS OF HISTORY**



OUR GOAL : MAKE SYROS A PRIME DESTINATION FOR MUSICIANS

And become one of the leading classical music festivals in the Mediterranean region



Masterclasses

Syros International Music Festival's **young artist program** offers a rich, immersive experience for the most committed and artistically driven young musicians seeking the opportunity to take their art to the highest level.

The program offers students a **multitude opportunities** to develop their technical and interactive skills under the tutelage of **Pinchas Zukerman**, **Tosca Opdam** and **Asi Matathias**.

Students get 3 (open to the public) masterclasses as well as career guidance session with the world renowned **Bernhard Kerres** (former CEO and artistic director of the **Vienna Konzerthaus**) and Executive business coach **Paul van der Schoot**.

Educational initiatives

During the festival, **musicians and local schools partner** to provide kids with a unique introduction to classical music with the goal to develop in the next years a school for chamber music on the island with year long collaborations with international institutions.

This program aims at :

- **Nurturing** the gifts of the next generation of classical musicians
- Fostering **emerging talent** and enriching the local artistic community.
- Impacting the Island's cultural landscape with classical music education.
- Developing **local partnerships** for community involvement.
- Offering music educational programs at **schools** throughout Syros.

THE UNIQUE ATTRACTIVENESS OF SYROS

A Perfect cultural setting to attract qualified audience

Syros,
The island of Culture

Nestled in the heart of the Aegean Sea, Syros boasts a rich tapestry of **history** and **culture**. The island has been home to a myriad of civilizations, including Romans, Arabs, Ottoman Turks, Franks, and Venetians. What sets Syros apart from other Greek islands is its **unique Venetian Catholic community**, which has thrived for over 500 years under the protection of Rome.

Syros is **a living museum of neoclassic architecture**, blending **medieval** charm with **Venetian** elegance. Marvel at the grandeur of the Town Hall and the Apollo Theater, quintessential examples of neoclassical design.

As we explore Syros, we encounter countless marble stairs, whitewashed houses with wooden balconies, and vividly painted doors.





Syros, **the jewel of the Cyclades**, is a captivating blend of stunning natural beauty, rich history, and vibrant culture.

With its **stunning sunny weather** and its cultural life, Syros offers an idyllic setting fostering artistic inspiration and represents a **strategic location** for music loving audiences.

OUR VISION FOR THE NEXT YEARS

Develop chamber music in Greece and establish Syros Festival as an international Brand

First Edition

- 2 Concerts
- 5 world class musicians
- 500 kids attended the outreach program
- Concerts for elderly people and kids with special needs
- National news coverage
- 20 000 EUR Budget among which 15 000 EUR sponsorship

Last Edition

- 5 Concerts
- 9 world class Musicians
- 1 masterclass promotion with Pinchas Zukerman
- 900 kids attended the outreach program
- National and international news coverage
- 80 000 EUR Budget among which 60 000 EUR sponsorship

Coming Edition

- 5 Concerts
- Participation of Pinchas Zukerman for the second consecutive year
- First partnership with China for an exclusive masterclass program
- 3 masterclass promotions with Pinchas Zukerman
- 1200 kids expected for the outreach program
- 180 000 EUR Budget with an expected 150 000 EUR sponsorship

International partnerships

- Concerts throughout the year in Syros and Athens
- Extended masterclass program throughout the year
- Partnerships with national and international conservatories
- Development of a school for chamber music on Syros
- Development of a Board of Education for the festival

Export the Syros Festival

- Open Syros Festival antennas in Europe and Asia
- Develop Festival with the Syros Festival brand in different parts of the world
- Create the Syros Festival Education Fund to provide children with instruments and access to chamber music education

Open the Syros Music School for chamber music

- Concerts throughout the year in Syros and Athens
- Extended masterclass program throughout the year
- Partnerships with national and international conservatories
- Development of a school for chamber music on Syros
- Development of a Board of Education for the festival

2023 | 2024 | 2025 | 2026 | 2027 | 2028

FESTIVAL 2024 HIGHLIGHTS

The second edition of the festival took place 19–23 nov 2024



The 2024 **Syros International Music Festival** was a resounding success, made possible by the **incredible artists** who delivered five magnificent concerts at the historic **Apollon Theater**.

Our heartfelt thanks go to our **partners** and **patrons**, whose support was invaluable, and to the enthusiastic local audience who embraced the festival with open arms.

#1 **WORLD PREMIERE PIECE FOR PIANO BY AMERICAN COMPOSER TODD MASON**

900 **CHILDREN PARTICIPATED IN THE OUTREACH PROGRAM**

1500 **TICKETS SOLD AT THE APOLLON THEATER**

15 **MASTERCLASS LESSONS**

24 **COUNTRIES REPRESENTED IN THE AUDIENCE**

1. Five Concerts at Apollon Theater



Artists



ASI MATATHIAS
Violin Israel / USA



TOSCA OPDAM
Violin Netherlands



VICTOR STANISLAVSKY
Piano Israel / Ukraine

TO BE CONFIRMED
Clarinet Belgium



TIMOTHEOS GAVRIILIDIS-PETRIN
Cello Greece



PINCHAS ZUKERMAN
Violin Israel / USA



AMANDA FORSYTH
Cello Canada



DIYANG MEI
Viola China



DAVID KADOUCH
Piano France



CHRISTINA POULITSI
Singer Greece

Concerts

TUE 21

Opening Concert

Beethoven Eyeglass Duo
Mozart piano quartet g minor
Mendelssohn string quintet nr. 2

WED 22

The Poet and the Muse

Schubert Trio
Saint-Saëns Poet et Muse
Brahms Clarinet Quintet

THU 23

The French connection

Stravinsky Histoire du soldat
Arias by **Gounod, Massenet, Delibes, Bizet**
Chausson Concerto for violin, piano and string quartet

FRI 24

Intimate pieces

Bach selection from two part, inventions
Yinam Leef Nocturne for viola and piano
Debussy Petite Suite for four hands
Schubert Quintet

SAT 25

Gala

Dvorak piano quintet
Brahms piano quintet

PROGRAM OF THE FESTIVAL 2025

2. An extended Masterclasses program

Syros International Music Festival's **young artist program** offers a rich, immersive experience for the most committed and artistically driven young musicians seeking the opportunity to take their art to the highest level.

Masterclass

The program offers students a **multitude opportunities** to develop their technical and interactive skills under the tutelage of **Pinchas Zukerman**, **Tosca Opdam** and **Asi Matathias**.

International students can submit their **application online** from **March 2025**.

The Masterclass program includes:

- **Housing**, Breakfasts and meals
- **3 masterclasses**
- **Coaching session** by Executive business coach Paul van der Schoot
- **Year long coaching** plan providing online courses and small group coaching by the world renowned Bernhard Kerres (former CEO and Artistic Director of the Vienna Konzerthaus)
- **Professional publicity** photo by the Festival's official photographer
- **Perform** intimate concerts in within the festival
- **Entry tickets** to all of the festival's concerts and events.



PROGRAM OF THE FESTIVAL 2025

3. An outreach program for children of the Cyclades Islands

In collaboration with the **Municipality of Hermoupolis**, and the local offices of the **Greek ministry of Education**, the festival invites every year all the public and private schools of Syros to attend morning concerts at **Apollon Theater**.

Concerts, Workshops and activities for 5-18 children

During the festival, **musicians and local schools partner** to provide kids with a unique introduction to classical music with the goal to develop in the next years a school for chamber music on the island with year long collaborations with international institutions.

This program aims at :

- **Nurturing** the gifts of the next generation of classical musicians
- Fostering **emerging talent** and enriching the local artistic community.
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PROGRAM OF THE FESTIVAL 2025

4. The Syros experience : Cultural activities for our international audience

During the Syros International Music Festival, a variety of enriching activities are organised :

Exhibitions

Syros hosts several artists who decided to make the island their base for creation. Musicians, painters, disgners or architects use the festival as an opportunity to show their work.

Sightseeing

Attendees of the festival can enjoy a guided tour of Syros, a welcome dinner with the artists for patrons and supporters, and a conference by WWF Greece on the environmental challenges facing Greek islands.

Activities

Other activities included visits to geological sites, cooking classes, an exhibition of local artists, a tour of the Museum of History in Hermoupolis, and a presentation of traditional dances by the century-old Women's Association.

These diverse offerings aim at providing a memorable and culturally immersive experience for all festival participants.









CORPORATE / ORGANISATION

Association / Board / Artistic and Executive team

Association "Meet the Violins”

Nonprofit Cultural Association of the Festival

- 20 Members and 5 Board members
- Local partnerships
- Local institutions

Festival’s Advisory board

Chairman of the Advisory Board

- Oversight and Accountability
- Supervision of the Executive Team
- Strategic Guidance
- Mentorship
- Evaluation and Feedback

Executive Team





TOSCA OPDAM & ASI MATATHIAS

Artistic Directors

- Creative Vision
- Musical program
- Masterclass artistic program
- Education musical program
- Fundraising



ALEX PIKIAKOS

Executive Director

- Leadership and Vision
- Fundraising
- Operational Oversight
- Team Management
- Finance
- Stakeholder Engagement
- Evaluation and Reporting



TANIA ATANASOVA

Program Manager

- Program Planning
- Team Coordination
- Project management
- Audience Services
- Ticketing
- Customer Service



MARGARITA ANGELOPOULOU

Local partnerships

- President of the association
- PR
- Fundraising
- Local institutions
- Schools and Activities

OUR ADVISORY BOARD

A committee of experts to provide Strategic Guidance to the executive Team of the festival

Advisory Board

Development



SAVVAS SPANIAS
Entrepreneur
Greece - Cyprus



AMINA HARRIS
Philanthropist
UK - Israel



CHIU-TI JANSEN
Entrepreneur
USA - Taiwan

Strategy



PAUL VAN DER SCHOOT
Strategy consultant
Market and Organisation



MICHAIL FRIEDMAN
Entrepreneur
Business Strategy

Careers



BERNHARD KERRES
Executive coach
Young Artists careers

Academy



YINAM LEEF
Composer



JUSTUS FRANTZ
Conductor

Our Advisory board consists in professionals, patrons and experts who help the Festival develop its vision, raise funds and develop its reputation worldwide.

The Board includes a sub-committee focusing exclusively on fund-raising. It is organised by regions : America, Asia, Europe, Great-Birtain, Middle-East and Greece and Cyprus.

For more information about the Fundraising opportunities, please contact : fundraising@syrosfestival.org

FUNDING OF THE FESTIVAL

Four sources of funding through sponsoring and partnerships

Corporate businesses

This year's **festival is seeking exclusive partnerships** with corporate businesses, preferably international brands. By associating their name with our renowned event, these partners will gain unparalleled visibility and engagement with our diverse and dedicated audience. We believe in creating mutually beneficial relationships that enhance the prestige and reach of both the festival and our esteemed partners.

Local partners

Since the first edition of the festival, strong partnerships with local businesses were developed. **Hotels**, **restaurants**, **travel agents**, galleries or cafes support its educational program and highlight the festival's commitment to delivering high-quality experiences **beyond the peak tourist season**.

Institutions

The Festival is supported by the **Municipality of Hermoupolis** and the **Region of the Cyclades**.

Our talented musicians hail from various countries, and the embassies of these nations are enthusiastic about partnering with us. Through these collaborations, the embassies actively support their artists, foster cultural exchange, and strengthen international ties through the universal language of music.

Friends

Our Supporters' program offers the possibility to **individuals** to support the festival and allow it to develop its strategy for the coming years.

The Festival has developed a **network of Supporters** around the globe who help promote, raise funds and develop the festival's reputation.

BECOME A FRIEND OF THE FESTIVAL

Support the development of the festival and access exclusive advantages



The Festival embraces its loyal audiences and offers them the possibility to commit even more to the festival by contributing financially to its development and, in return, benefit from exclusive advantages.

Join the **circle of Friends(*)** of the Festival and extend your experience beyond Music.

FRIEND
75 €

- ✓ Your name listed as a supporter of the festival
- ✓ Invitations to the friend's nights
- ✓ Priority entry to masterclasses
- ✓ Exclusive access to the festival's pre-sale ticket service
- ✓ 20% off up to 2 tickets per concert
- ✓ Priority access to the festival's activities : the Syros experience
- ✓ Copy of the Festival's printed program

DONOR
500 €

All the benefits of the Friend card plus :

- ✓ 2 Complimentary Category 1 tickets to the Gala Concert
- ✓ 20% off up to 2 tickets per concert
- ✓ Exclusive access to the Festival ticket office for a more personalised service
- ✓ Priority access to short open rehearsals

BENEFACTOR
1 000 €

All the benefits of the Donor card plus :

- ✓ Meeting with the masterclass teachers and students
- ✓ Two complimentary glasses of Champagne at the friends Bar
- ✓ Invitation to private cocktail party at Aristide Hotel with artists
- ✓ Access to the welcome dinner with artists

PATRON
2 500 €

All the benefits of the Benefactor card plus :

- ✓ Private concert at the neoclassical 'Residence 1860' in Ermoupoli
- ✓ Guaranteed booking availability at Aristide Luxury Hotel until august 30th
- ✓ Concierge service for all your needs on the island (car rental, chauffeur, tour guide and restaurant booking)

(*) "Should you wish to make a larger contribution to our festival, please don't hesitate to **contact us**. We would be delighted to provide you with additional benefits and services."

BUDGET OF THE FESTIVAL

Income	Income	Cost	Number	Estimated €	
Ticket Sales					
	Premium	100 €	150	15.000 €	
	Regular seats	20 €	750	15.000 €	
	Total Ticket Revenue			**30.000 €**	**19%**
Masterclasses fees					
	Violin Masterclass	1.000 €	8	8.000 €	
	Clarinet Masterclass	800 €	4	3.200 €	
	Total Masterclasses Revenue			**11.200 €**	**7%**
Donations and Fundraising					
	Grants			40.000 €	
	Funding Partner	25.000 €	1	25.000 €	
	Patrons	10.000 €	2	20.000 €	
	Benefactors	5.000 €	2	10.000 €	
	Donors	2.000 €	5	10.000 €	
	Friends	500 €	10	5.000 €	
	Minor Sponsorships			10.000 €	
	Total Donations and Fundraising			**120.000 €**	**74%**
	Total Revenue			**161.200 €**	

Expenses	Cost	Number	Estimated €	
Venue			**2.400 €**	**2%**
Artists				
Fees			40.000 €	
Travel			20.000 €	
Accommodation			18.000 €	
Restaurant			4.000 €	
Total Artist Expenses			**82.000 €**	**51%**
Masterclasses				
Artist Fees			5.000 €	
Accommodation			10.000 €	
Restaurant			3.000 €	
Total Masterclasses Expenses			**18.000 €**	**11%**
Outreach Program				
Artist Fees			2.400 €	
Animation			3.000 €	
Total Outreach Program Expenses			**5.400 €**	**3%**
Activities				
Animations			3.000 €	
Restaurant	50 €	20	1.000 €	
Total Activities Expenses			**4.000 €**	**2%**
Organisation				
Staff	12.000 €	2	24.000 €	
Other	2.000 €	1	2.000 €	
Total Organisation Expenses			**26.000 €**	**16%**
Marketing				
Website	8.000 €	1	8.000 €	
Social Media and Newsletter	400 €	7	2.800 €	
Online advertisment	1.000 €	1	1.000 €	
Photography	2.000 €	1	2.000 €	
Videography	3.000 €	1	3.000 €	
Print	3.500 €	1	3.500 €	
PR	3.000 €	1	3.000 €	
Total Marketing Expenses			**23.300 €**	**14%**
Total Expenses			**161.100 €**	

TRAVEL AGENTS EXCLUSIVE PACKAGES

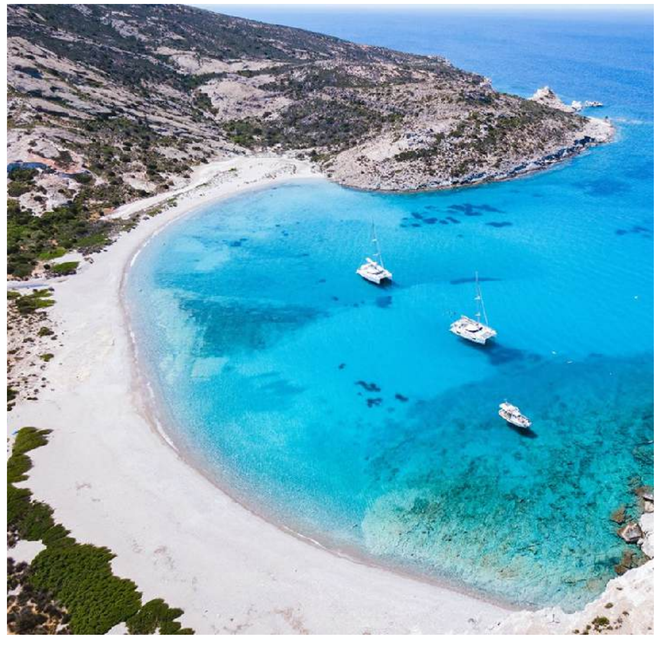
The Festival offers special Packages for its international audience

Travel agents can contact the Festival directly to provide their client with an all-in-one package. Including travel, accommodation, concerts and activities.

Our offer includes three PASSES.

We can help agents negotiating with local **luxury hotels** and **restaurants** and travel agencies for transportation, **sailing cruises**, trips to the surrounding islands and more.

Feel free to **contact us** for more information.



600 € Musical PASS

EXCLUSIVE PREMIUM TICKETS FOR THE 5 CONCERTS

- ✓ **5 Premium Tickets** (best parterre or premium boxes seats) for the five concerts at Apollon Theatre
- ✓ **Free access** to all **masterclass sessions** by Pinchas Zukerman, Tosca Opdam and Asi Matathias
- ✓ **Exclusive Access to recital** of Masterclass students in a major historical location of Syros
- ✓ **Meet the artists** at the Patrons and artists bar

400 € Activities PASS

- ✓ **2 guided tours** of Hermoupolis with local (English speaking) guides
- ✓ **Free Entrance to all the museums** of Hermoupolis : Historical Museum, Textile Museum, Industrial Museum and Archeological museum,
- ✓ **A Geological tour of Syros**
- ✓ **A Hicking** visit of the north of the island with its prehistorical settlements
- ✓ **A free Cooking class** by traditional cuisine cook Elisa (+100 EUR per person)
- ✓ **Free access** to all other activities

1300 € Extended PASS

- ✓ **Includes both Musical and activities PASSES**
- ✓ Contribution to the **Festival Education Fund**
- ✓ Exclusive access to a private concert for our international Audience

TRAVEL AND ACCOMMODATION

Our supporters program will enable the festival to grow and further develop its educational initiatives on Syros.

Travel to Syros

FLIGHTS

Syros has a **national airport** that connects the island **with the International Airport of Athens**.

The airport is located only 3 kilometers from Hermoupolis and can be reached by taxi or private means of transport.

There is also a possibility to fly to **Paros** or **Mykonos** and connect to Syros with a Ferry.

FERRY

From Athens airport travelers can easily take an airport taxi direct to the Piraeus Harbor for the ferry to Syros.

There are **daily ferries between Syros and Athens.**

Accommodation

Festival hotels are specially open for our guests during the dates of the festival. Special conditions for the guests of the festival have been negotiated. A complete list of partnering hotels is available upon request.






Payment policy
A prepayment of 50% of the total rate is required upon confirmation. The remaining 50% is due seven days before your arrival.

Cancellation policy
Cancellations can be made free of charge up to seven days before your arrival. If you cancel within seven days of your arrival, a cancellation fee of 100% of the total rate will apply. In the event of a no-show, the cancellation fee will also be 100% of the total rate.

More hotels
The festival has developped a network of hotels and Luxury Suites. Don't hesiste to contact us and we can recommend them to you.

SYROS INTERNATIONAL MUSIC **FESTIVAL 2025**

DEMONSTRATING THE HARMONY OF MUSIC AND CULTURE



BECOME A SUPPORTER

And support
the development
of chamber music
for generations
to come

Partnerships Manager



SPYROS TZERIS
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Executive Director



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Artistic Directors



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